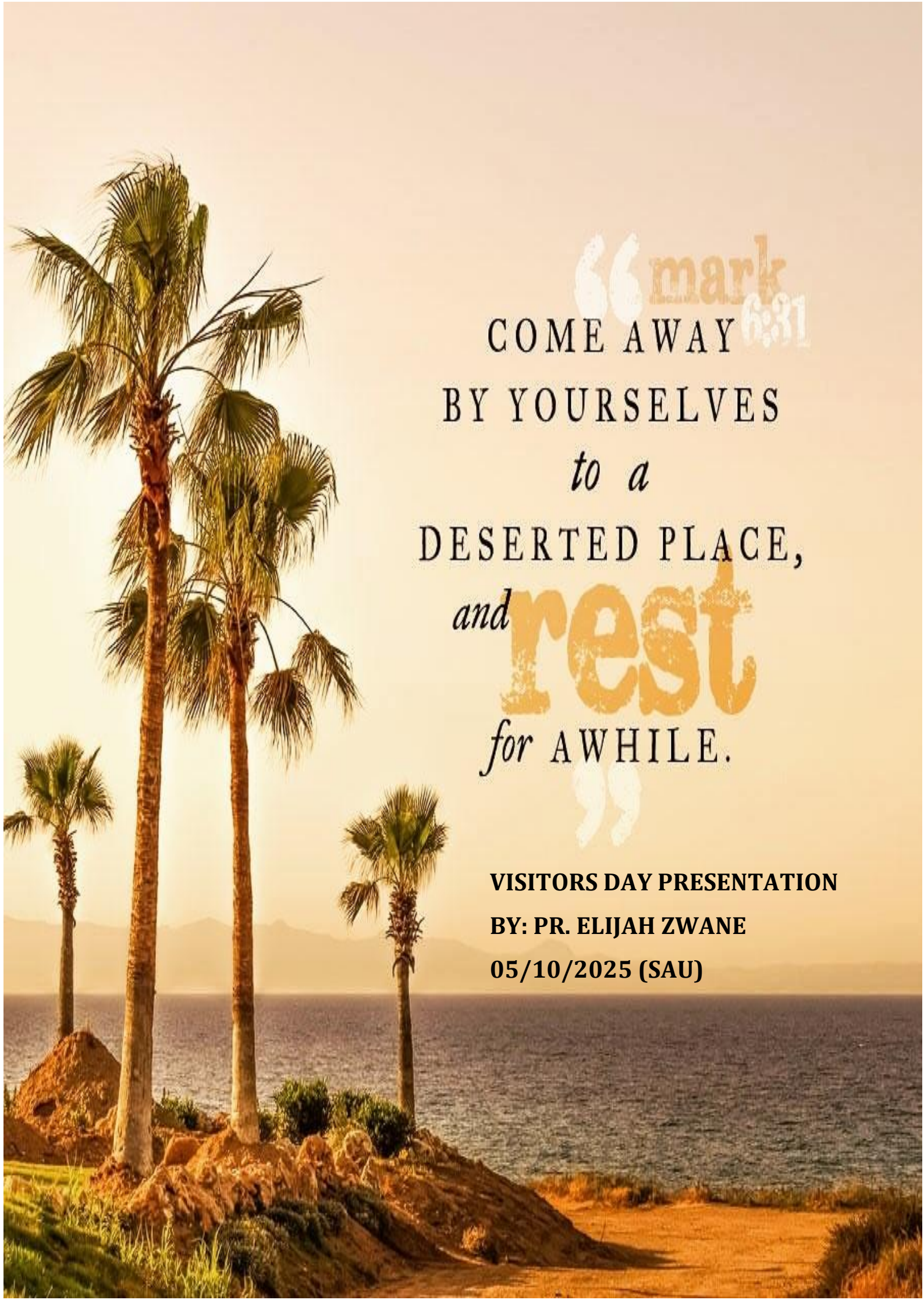




“mark
COME AWAY 6:31
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DESERTED PLACE,
and rest
for AWHILE.”

VISITORS DAY PRESENTATION

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"Come away by yourselves to a deserted place and rest a while" **Mark 6:31**

Come Rest: Physically
Mentally, and
Emotionally

SABBATH REST

"By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work. Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done."

Genesis 2:2-3

God did not rest because he was tired he saw it fit for humanity to institute the Sabbath as we shall see.

Theories about the earth forming from some activities billions of years ago are clearly contrary to the bible, for it states that it only took God six days to create the whole world.

"Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy"

It means He set it aside for a special purpose, he created it, and there are blessings upon the keeping of the Sabbath

"Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the Lord your God. On it you shall not do any work, neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your male or female servant, nor your animals, nor any foreigner residing in your towns. For in six days the Lord made the heavens and the earth, the sea, and all that is in them, but he rested on the seventh day. Therefore the Lord blessed the Sabbath day and made it holy." **Exodus 20:8-11**

"Remember": This shows that at the time of writing the commandments at mount Sinai, it was just a reminder and had already

been established before, like other laws. The following were rebuked for breaking it:

- Cain killed his brother: murder
- Jacob took Esau's blessings: covetousness
- Abraham lied about his wife: false witness

SABBATH AS A SIGN

"For six days work is to be done, but the seventh day is a day of Sabbath rest, holy to the Lord. Whoever does any work on the Sabbath day is to be put to death. The Israelites are to observe the Sabbath, celebrating it for the generations to come as a lasting covenant. It will be a sign between me and the Israelites forever, for in six days the Lord made the heavens and the earth, and on the seventh day he rested and was refreshed." **Exodus 31:15-18**

"Also I gave them my Sabbaths as a sign between us, so they would know that I the Lord made them holy." **Ezekiel 20:12**

The Sabbath was given to be a sign between God and his people.

GATHERING OF MANNA

"Then the Lord said to Moses, 'I will rain down bread from heaven for you. The people are to go out each day and gather enough for that day. In this way I will test them and see whether they will follow my instructions. On the sixth day they are to prepare what they bring in, and that is to be twice as much as they gather on the other days.' However, some of them paid no attention to Moses; they kept part of it until morning, but it was full of maggots and began to smell. So Moses was angry with them. Each morning everyone gathered as much as they needed, and when the sun grew hot, it melted away. On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much—two

omers for each person—and the leaders of the community came and reported this to Moses. He said to them, ‘This is what the LORD commanded: ‘Tomorrow is to be a day of Sabbath rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. So bake what you want to bake and boil what you want to boil. Save whatever is left and keep it until morning.’ So they saved it until morning, as Moses commanded, and it did not stink or get maggots in it. ‘Eat it today,’ Moses said, ‘because today is a Sabbath to the LORD. You will not find any of it on the ground today. Six days you are to gather it, but on the seventh day, the Sabbath, there will not be any.’ Bear in mind that the Lord has given you the Sabbath; that is why on the sixth day he gives you bread for two days.”

Exodus 16:4, 5, 20-26, 29

God provided manna for them, otherwise known as bread of heaven or bread of angels because they were the ones that brought it.

From Sunday to Friday they were to gather each only enough for that day, but on Friday they collected for two days because on Saturday the angels did not come to rain bread for it was the Sabbath. On Sabbath morning, unlike all the other mornings, the bread was still fresh and without maggots.

“Yet the people of Israel rebelled against me in the wilderness. They did not follow my decrees but rejected my laws—by which the person who obeys them will live—and they utterly desecrated my Sabbaths. So I said I would pour out my wrath on them and destroy them in the wilderness.” **Ezekiel 20:13**

One of the reasons why the Israel was taken to captivity was desecrating the Sabbath.

“...and they shut their eyes to the keeping of my Sabbaths, so that I am profaned among them.” **Ezekiel 22:26**

Do not the priests of today shut their eyes from the Sabbath as did of old.

“This is what the Lord says: ‘Maintain justice and do what is right, for my salvation is close at hand and my righteousness will soon be revealed. Blessed is the one who does this—the person who holds it fast, who keeps the Sabbath without desecrating it, and keeps their hands from doing any evil. Let no foreigner who is bound to the Lord say, The Lord will surely exclude me from his people. And let no eunuch complain, ‘I am only a dry tree.’” **Isaiah 56:1-3**

The Sabbath was not only for the Jews (Let no foreigner who is bound to the Lord say, the Lord will surely exclude me from his people).

DID JESUS ABOLISH THE SABBATH?

“Do not think that I have come to abolish the Law or the Prophets; I have not come to abolish them but to fulfill them.” **Matthew 5:17**

“He went to Nazareth, where he had been brought up, and on the Sabbath day he went into the synagogue, as was his custom. He stood up to read,” **Luke 4:16**
It was a custom of Jesus to gather and preach on the Sabbath

“As Paul and Barnabas were leaving the synagogue, the people invited them to speak further about these things on the next Sabbath...On the next Sabbath almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord.” **Acts 13:42, 44**

The apostles continued gathering and teaching on the Sabbath even after Jesus’s death.

WHICH DAY IS THE SABBATH?

“It was Preparation Day, and the Sabbath was about to begin. The women who had

come with Jesus from Galilee followed Joseph and saw the tomb and how his body was laid in it. Then they went home and prepared spices and perfumes. But they rested on the Sabbath in obedience to the commandment.” **Luke 23:54-56**

“After the Sabbath, at dawn on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb.”

(Early on Sunday morning, as the new day was dawning, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went out to visit the tomb. NLT) **Matthew 28:1**

It was on Friday when Jesus died, after the Sabbath here refers to Sunday.

Also note that Friday is the preparation day (It was Preparation Day, and the Sabbath was about to begin). On Friday, at evening after sunset begins the Sabbath, the author writes that it was about to begin.

THE LORD'S DAY

“Then he said to them, ‘The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath. So the Son of Man is Lord even of the Sabbath.’” **Mark 2:27-28**

The Sabbath was made to benefit man out of love and not otherwise. Jesus replied to his accusers by affirming His Sonship to God, and declaring that He worked in harmony with the Father.

So with the Sabbath, it was designed to bring men and women into communion with God; but when the mind is absorbed with wearisome rites, the object of the Sabbath is thwarted. It is the service of love that God values and Jesus had to teach this to the heartless Pharisees.

“Then Jesus asked them, “Which is lawful on the Sabbath: to do good or to do evil, to save life or to kill?” But they remained silent.” **Mark 3:4**

“If I speak in the tongues of men or of angels, but do not have love, I am only a

resounding gong or a clanging cymbal. If I have the gift of prophecy and can fathom all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have a faith that can move mountains, but do not have love, I am nothing. If I give all I possess to the poor and give over my body to hardship that I may boast, but do not have love, I gain nothing.” **1 Corinthians 13:1-3**

By its connection with error, the truth had been serving the cause of the enemy of God and man. Christ had come to place it where it would glorify God, and work the salvation of humanity.

Because the Sabbath was made for mankind, it is the Lord's day. It belongs to Christ. For “all things were made by Him; and without Him was not anything made that was made.” (**John 1:3**) Since He made all things, He made the Sabbath. By Him it was set apart as a memorial of the work of creation. It points to Him as both the Creator and the Sanctifier.

The Lord of the Sabbath, if we love him we will observe His day. **1 John 2:3-6; 5:2-4; John 14:15** emphasize that if we love the Lord, we will observe all his commandments.

“On the Lord's Day I was in the Spirit, and I heard behind me a loud voice like a trumpet,” **Revelation 1:10**

The Sabbath day is not for somebody's choosing, it is the Lord's day. He rested on no other day but that, one can't choose when he rested.

God calls it my day in **Isaiah 58:13**

“If you keep your feet from breaking the Sabbath and from doing as you please on my holy day,”

“As the new heavens and the new earth that I make will endure before me,’ declares the Lord, ‘so will your name and descendants endure. From one New Moon to another and from one Sabbath to

another, all mankind will come and bow down before me,' says the Lord." **Isaiah 66:22-23**

So long as the heavens and the earth endure, the Sabbath will continue as a sign of the Creator's power. And when Eden shall bloom on earth again, God's holy rest day will be honored by all beneath the sun. "From one Sabbath to another" the inhabitants of the glorified new earth shall go up "to worship before me, saith the Lord.

IS GOD SO PARTICULAR OF THE DAY?

Remember Adam and Eve were given all trees for food but not the one in the middle. So much misery resulted from picking of just that wrong fruit, much shall come from picking the wrong day.

"For whoever keeps the whole law and yet stumbles at just one point is guilty of breaking all of it." **James 2:10** (If stumbling at one means this much, what more removing one?)

HOW TO KEEP THE SABBATH?

"If you keep your feet from breaking the Sabbath and from doing as you please on my holy day, if you call the Sabbath a delight and the Lord's holy day honorable, and if you honor it by not going your own way and not doing as you please or speaking idle words then you will find your joy in the Lord," **Isaiah 58:13**

God enjoins us to keep this day holy by resting from work, worshiping Him, and performing religious service.

On Friday (preparation day) all preparation for the seventh day should be finished. This includes food preparation for the Sabbath day, house cleaning, preparing one's clothing, and bathing, so we can begin the Sabbath day in peace and quiet. (**Exodus 16:23**)

On this day all differences between brethren, whether in the family or in the church, should be put away. In a humble spirit, "confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed." **James 5:16**

On the Sabbath, we are to abstain from all secular and business travel, conversation, and activities. Our conversation should be of a spiritual character and be for God's praise and our spiritual edification. God has directed that the sick and suffering be cared for; the labour required to make them comfortable is a work of mercy, and no violation of the Sabbath; but all unnecessary work should be avoided.

In harmony with the order of creation, a day begins and ends at sunset. Therefore, the Sabbath begins on Friday evening at sunset and ends on Sabbath evening at sunset.

Do consider that "Six days you shall labor" is also part of the 4th commandment. How one conducts themselves in these six days should also reflect and be part of Sabbath keeping. Along the week we prepare, wash and iron the clothes, buy and prepare the foods, knowing that there is a Sabbath coming, on which we shall rest from all worldly toils and 'enter into His rest with Him.'

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE SABBATH

"The law is only a shadow of the good things that are coming" **Hebrews 10:1**

The Sabbath is a foretaste of eternal life in God's kingdom. As we prepare in six days we are constantly reminded that the eternal rest to prepare for. Ensuring that when the Sabbath starts, everything should be in order and done is another reminder that when Jesus comes to take his own, he will take those that are ready. Remember the parable of ten virgins, "Those who were

ready went in with Him, and ‘the door was shut’” And those who were not shut in, were Shut out.

The divine rest day is the special sign of His obedient children in the end times.

(Exodus 31:15-18, Ezekiel 20:12)

To all who receive the Sabbath as a sign of Christ’s creative and redeeming power, it will be a delight. Seeing Christ in it, they delight themselves in Him. The Sabbath points them to the works of creation as an evidence of His mighty power in redemption. While it calls to mind the lost peace of Eden, it tells of peace restored through the Savior.

CONCLUSION

“For anyone who enters God’s rest also rests from their works, just as God did from his. Let us, therefore, make every effort to enter that rest, so that no one will perish by following their example of disobedience.”

Hebrews 4:10-11

“Now all has been heard; here is the conclusion of the matter: Fear God and keep his commandments, for this is the duty of all mankind. For God will bring every deed into judgment, including every hidden thing, whether it is good or evil.”

Eccelesiastes 12:13-14

“‘Come now, let us settle the matter,’ says the Lord. ‘Though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they are red as crimson, they shall be like wool.’” **Isaiah 1:18**

The Lord will receive the sinner when he repents and forsakes his sins so that God can work with his efforts in seeking perfection of character.

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